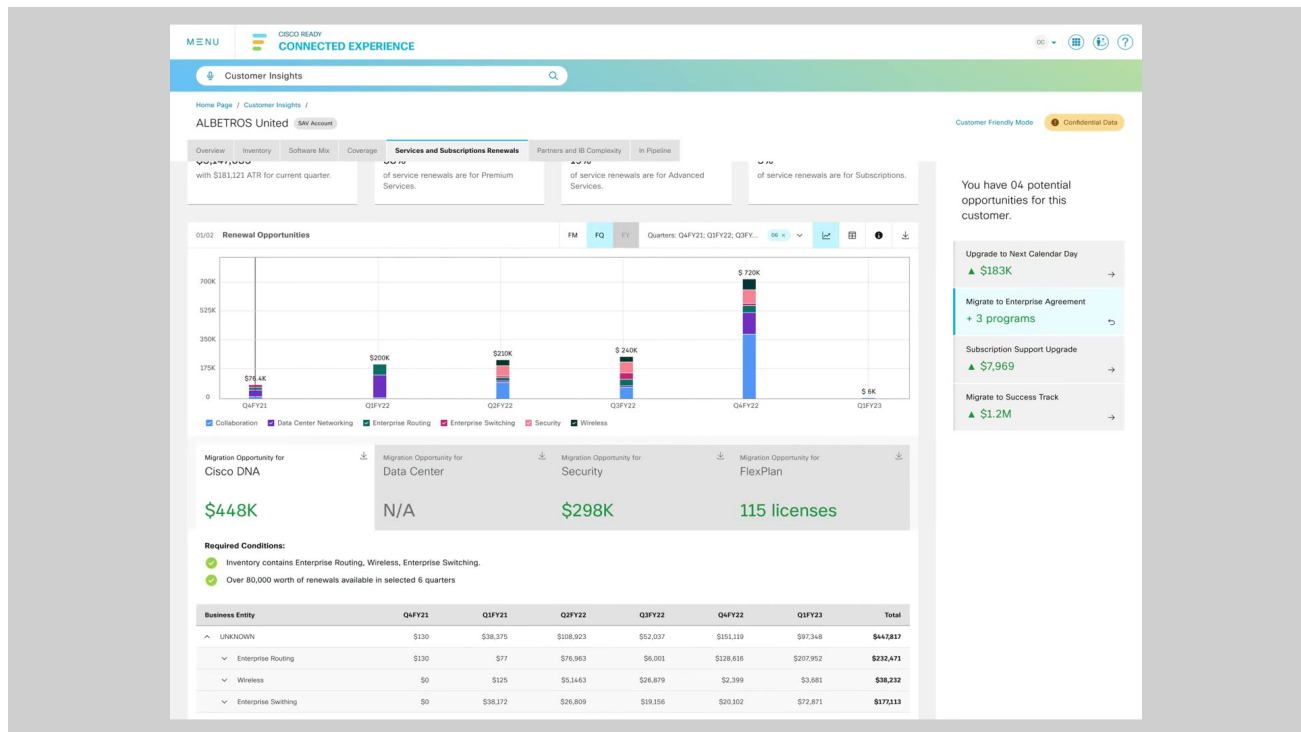


Designing Customer Insights and extending it with Upsell Opportunities.

Source: /work/cisco-customer-insights/



Video poster | Alt text: Designing Customer Insights and extending it with Upsell Opportunities. | Source asset: /assets/cisco/video/opportunity-extension-flow.webm

Customer Insights began as an underused Cisco dashboard. I led the research and redesign around the questions account teams asked while preparing for customer meetings. Its user base grew 40% within three months of the redesign.

As more people used Customer Insights, Cisco teams responsible for upgrades and buying programs asked to add their offers to the dashboard. I designed a framework for adding those offers one at a time and reusing data already available in Customer Insights.

Stakeholder: Cisco Ready

Skills: Product Discovery Information Architecture Platform Design

Year: 2020-21 (two phases)

Role: Sole Product Designer • Team

The team

- Monika Zochowska Product Manager
- Romualda Dziadosz Lead Data Analyst

- Fitim Sallahu Sr. Manager, Data Analytics
- Shravan Choutti Lead Backend Engineer
- Baljinder Kaur Lead Frontend Engineer

Researching Account Strategy

The existing page gave account managers a broad overview of a customer. To prepare a strategy, they still had to gather information from several internal tools and build their own pivot tables.

I focused the interviews on participants' two most recent customer meetings because meeting preparation was one of the few times account teams gathered all the information they needed to develop a strategy.

I interviewed 12 participants across three countries. Most managers described a short set of questions they tried to answer while developing a customer strategy, and their pivot tables showed how they combined information that the dashboard kept separate.

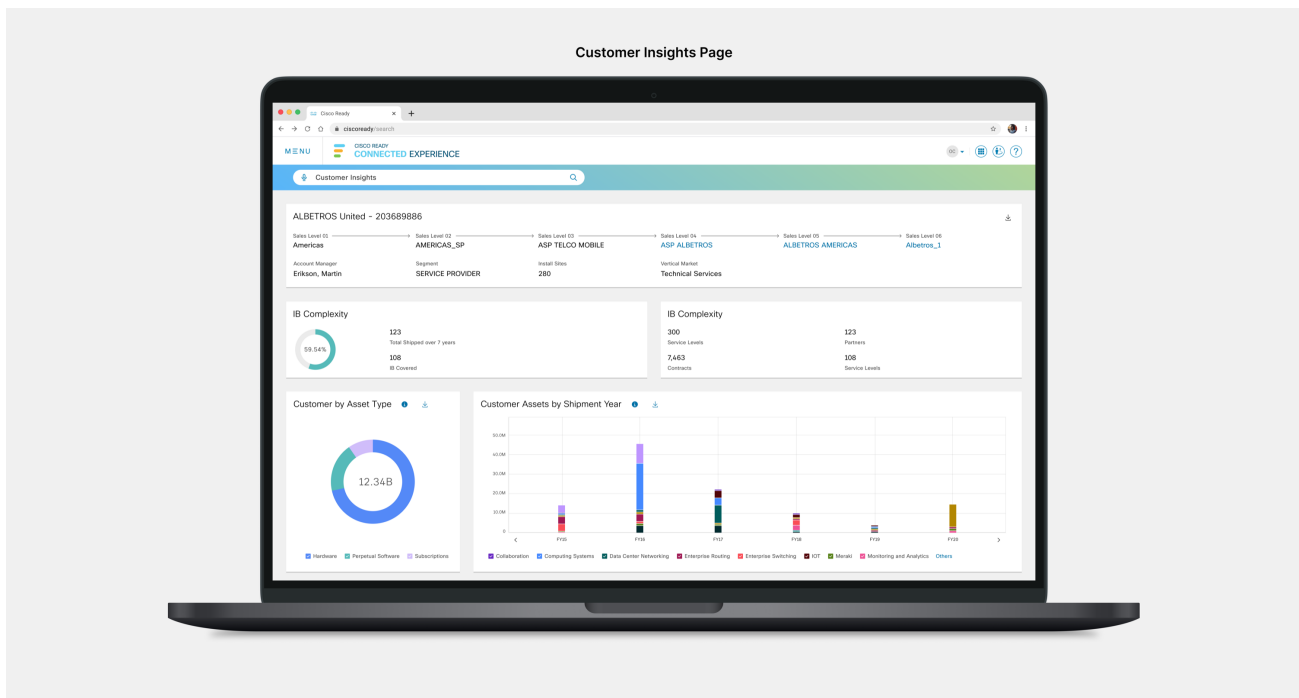


Image | Alt text: Previous Customer Insights dashboard | Caption: The previous dashboard summarized the account. Users gathered the information needed for further analysis from other tools. | Source asset: /assets/cisco/previous-dashboard.png

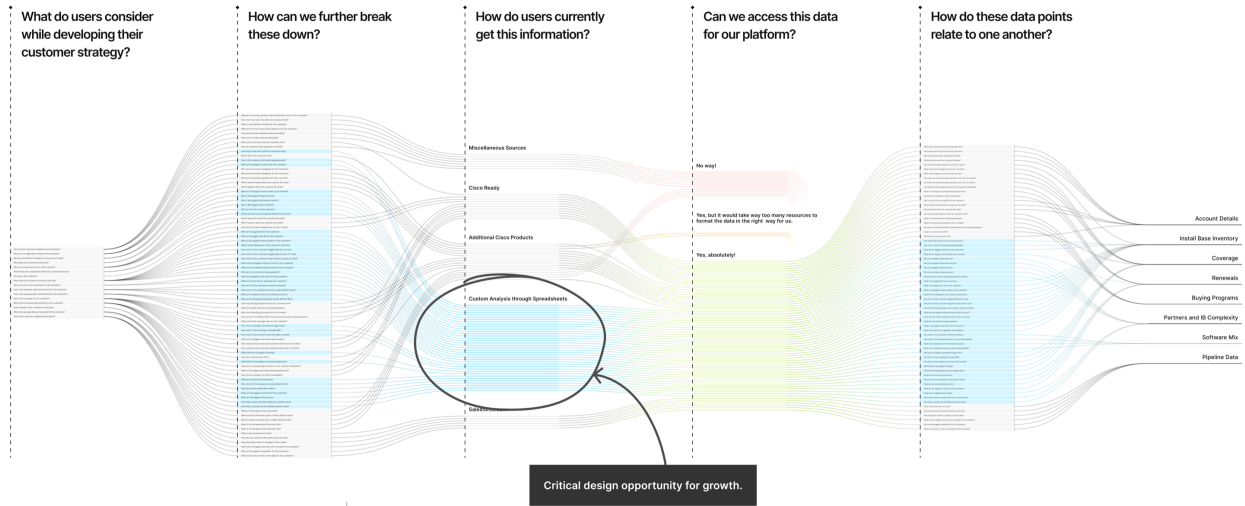


Image | Alt text: Framework connecting customer strategy questions to accessible data | Caption: I mapped the questions from the interviews to their data sources and checked which information Customer Insights could access. | Source asset: /assets/cisco/strategy-sensemaking.png

Designing Reusable Insight Modules

I designed visualizations to answer the questions account managers considered while developing a customer strategy.

I organized those visualizations into repeatable modules so users could move from a summary into the underlying data. One module used expandable table rows, and the same interaction could be reused across different datasets.

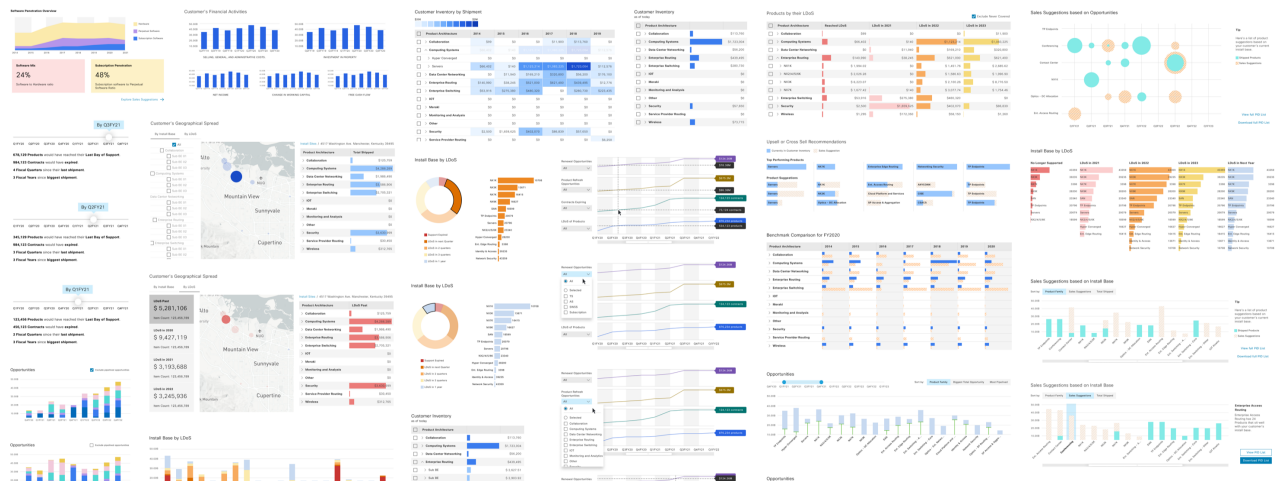


Image | Alt text: Board of data visualization concepts | Caption: Visualization studies tested how the same customer question could move from a quick signal to a detailed analysis. | Source asset: /assets/cisco/visualization-ideation.png

Business Entity	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	Total Revenue
Collaboration	\$1,362,125	\$955,290	\$815,125	\$1,058,885	\$713,290	\$5,512,585	\$5
Enterprise Systems	\$5,512,585	\$1,362,125	\$955,290	\$815,125	\$1,058,885	\$713,290	\$5,512,585
Cloud Center Management	\$1,362,125	\$955,290	\$815,125	\$1,058,885	\$713,290	\$5,512,585	\$5,512,585
Enterprise Mobility	\$1,362,125	\$955,290	\$815,125	\$1,058,885	\$713,290	\$5,512,585	\$5,512,585
Enterprise Security	\$1,362,125	\$955,290	\$815,125	\$1,058,885	\$713,290	\$5,512,585	\$5,512,585
IT	\$1,362,125	\$955,290	\$815,125	\$1,058,885	\$713,290	\$5,512,585	\$5,512,585
Mobile	\$1,362,125	\$955,290	\$815,125	\$1,058,885	\$713,290	\$5,512,585	\$5,512,585
Network Services	\$1,362,125	\$955,290	\$815,125	\$1,058,885	\$713,290	\$5,512,585	\$5,512,585
Other	\$1,362,125	\$955,290	\$815,125	\$1,058,885	\$713,290	\$5,512,585	\$5,512,585
Security	\$1,362,125	\$955,290	\$815,125	\$1,058,885	\$713,290	\$5,512,585	\$5,512,585
Service Provider Mobility	\$1,362,125	\$955,290	\$815,125	\$1,058,885	\$713,290	\$5,512,585	\$5,512,585
Wireless	\$1,362,125	\$955,290	\$815,125	\$1,058,885	\$713,290	\$5,512,585	\$5,512,585
Total	\$12,344,462	\$8,873,832	\$6,884,428	\$10,882,520	\$11,638,674	\$12,748,881	\$6,282,888

Business Entity	First Qtr	1st Qtr in 2015	2nd Qtr in 2015	3rd Qtr in 2015	4th Qtr in 2015	Future Revenue
Collaboration	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125
Enterprise Systems	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125
Cloud Center Management	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125
Enterprise Mobility	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125
Enterprise Security	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125
IT	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125
Mobile	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125
Network Services	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125
Other	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125
Security	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125
Service Provider Mobility	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125
Wireless	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125	\$1,362,125

Video poster | Alt text: Reusable data table module expanding and collapsing rows | Caption: The reusable table module moved between collapsed summaries and expanded rows without leaving the page. | Source asset: /assets/cisco/video/data-table-module.webm

Testing Dashboard Concepts

To decide where users should begin, I translated one product question into two opposing principles. Concept 01 gave users a catalog of visualizations and the freedom to decide what mattered. Concept 02 curated metrics against predefined benchmarks so the dashboard could recommend where to look first.

Participants preferred the guided starting point because it helped them choose a next step before reading a chart. Customer differences made benchmark colors unreliable, so the final design kept the tile hierarchy and removed benchmark-based status colors.

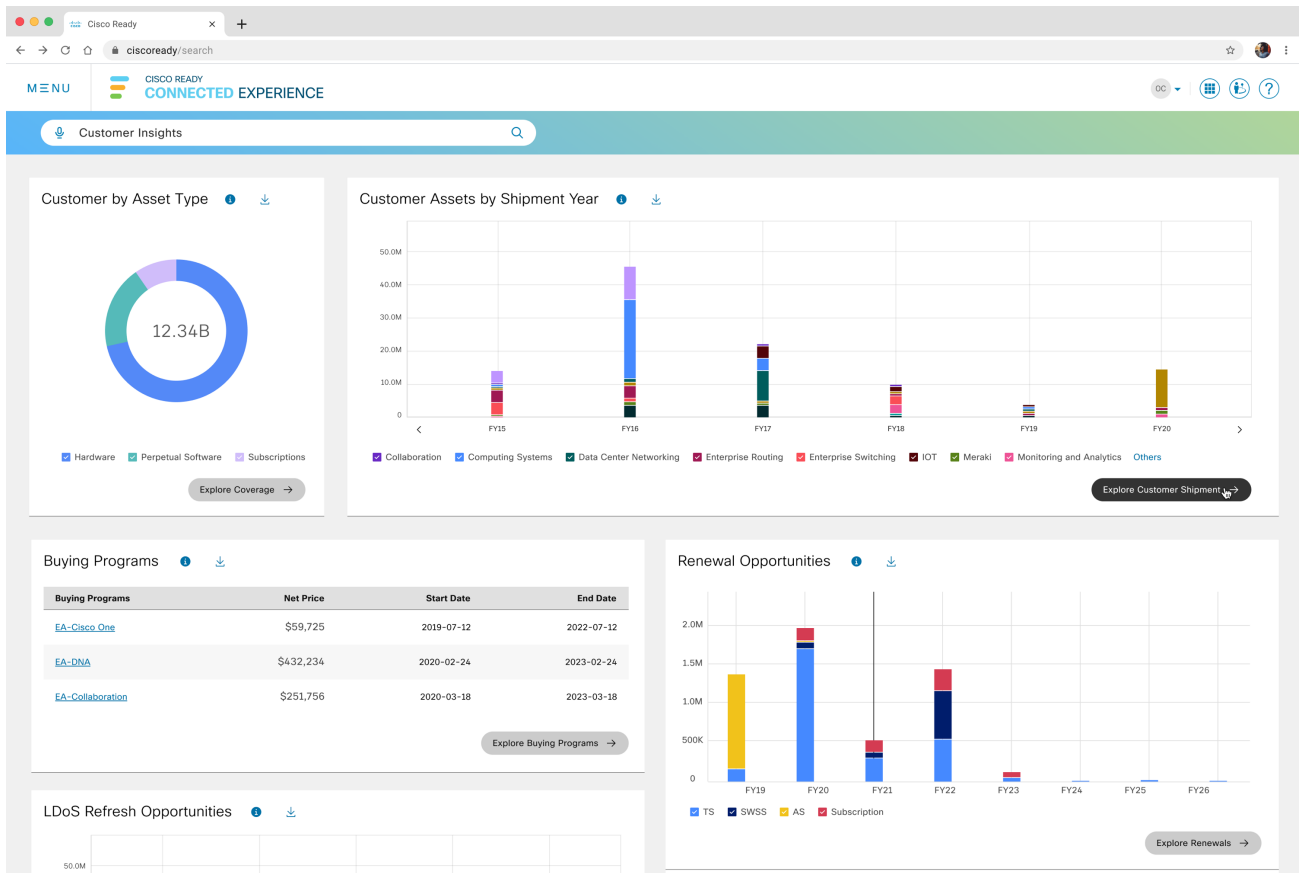


Image | Alt text: Exploratory chart-led dashboard concept | Caption: Concept 01 gave users cataloged visualizations and the freedom to decide what mattered. | Source asset: /assets/cisco/exploratory-concept.png

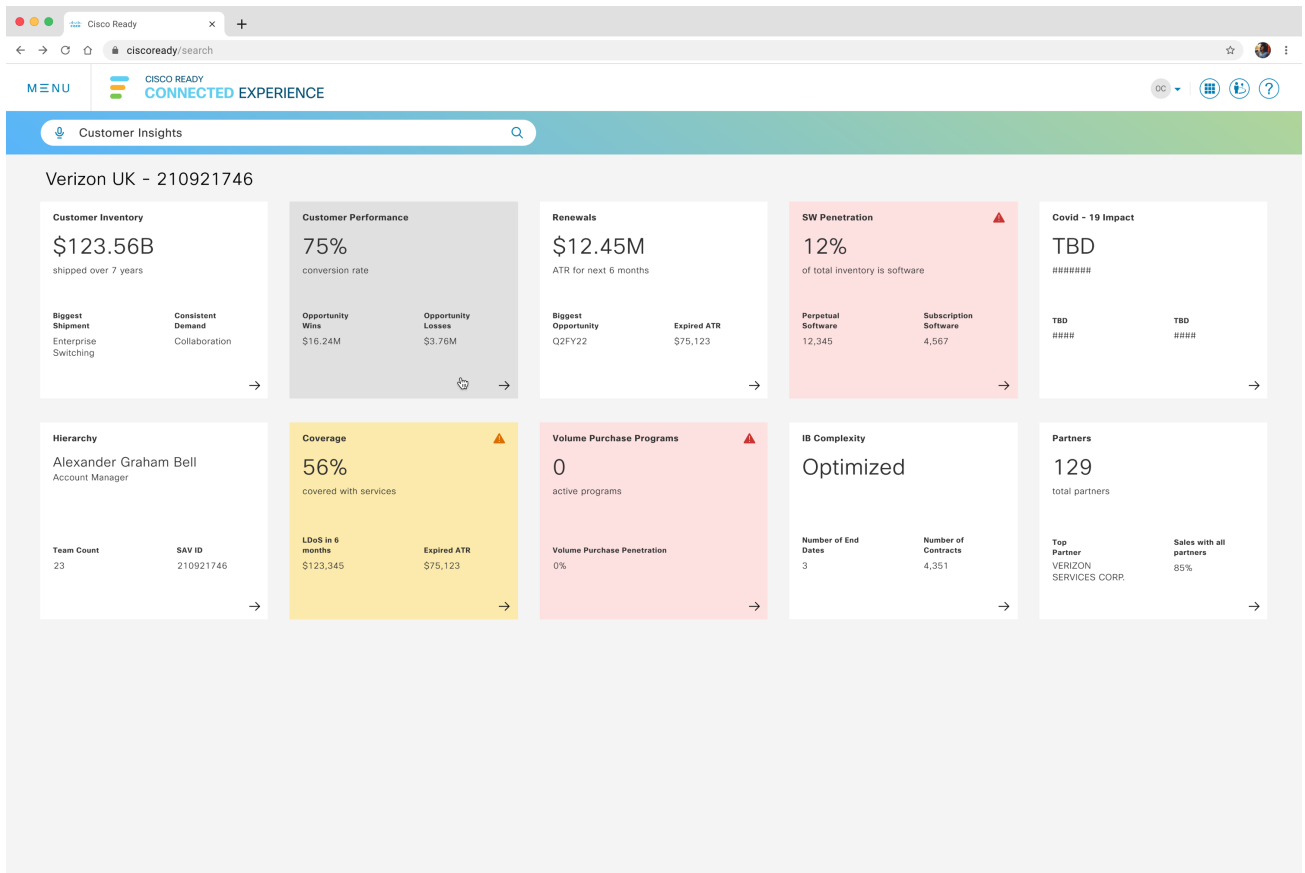
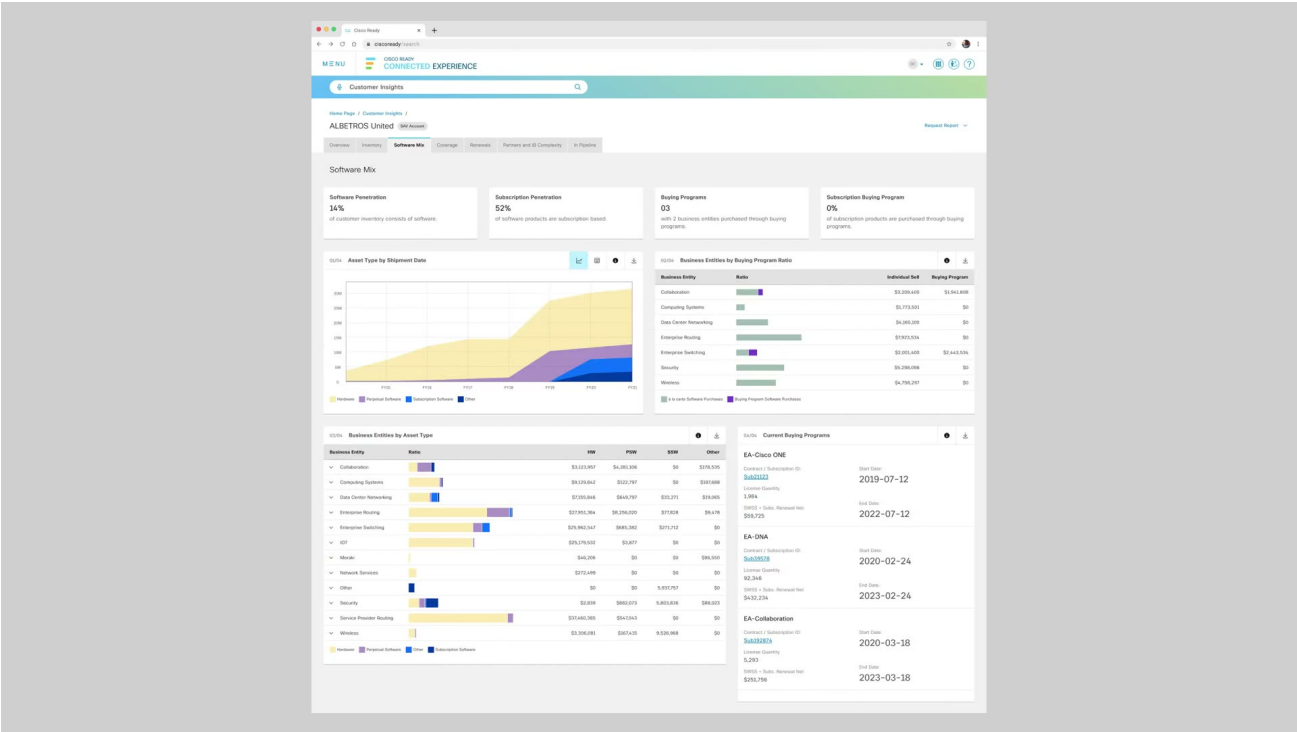


Image | Alt text: Benchmark-guided metric tile dashboard concept | Caption: Concept 02 used predefined benchmarks to recommend a starting point. | Source asset: /assets/cisco/guided-concept.png



Video poster | Alt text: Customer Insights dashboard workflow | Caption: The final dashboard organized the account around six questions. Each module opened with a headline measure, followed by charts and tables. | Source asset: /assets/cisco/video/customer-insights-flow.webm

Impact of Phase One

Over the three months after the redesign, the number of users grew by 40%.

That growth showed program teams where account managers were spending their time, so they began asking to add upgrades and buying-program offers to Customer Insights. Each offer required its own data validation and backend integration, and we could only add one at a time. I needed a repeatable way to add more offers later.

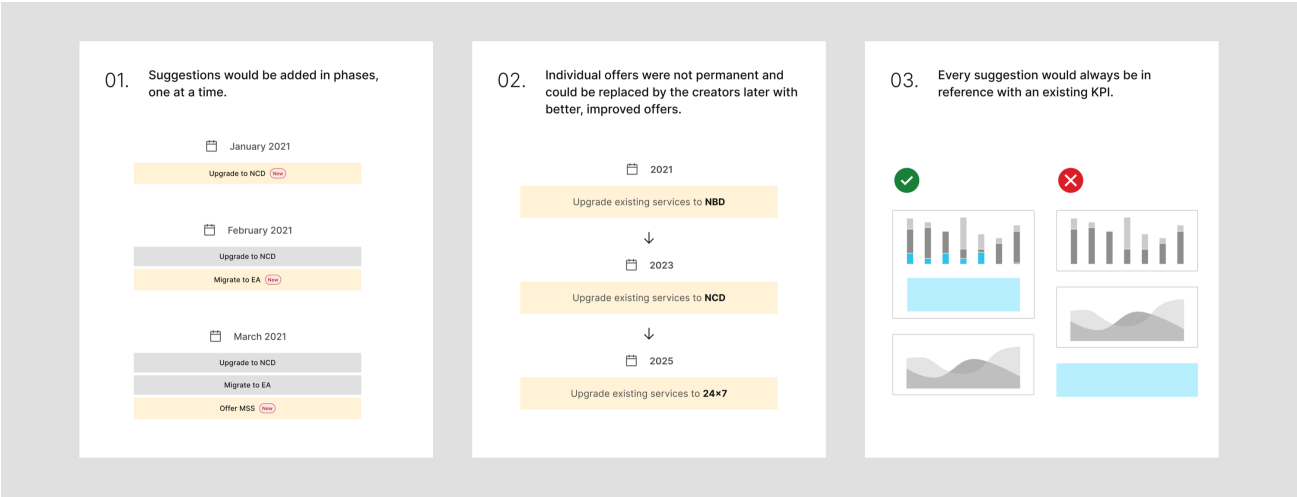
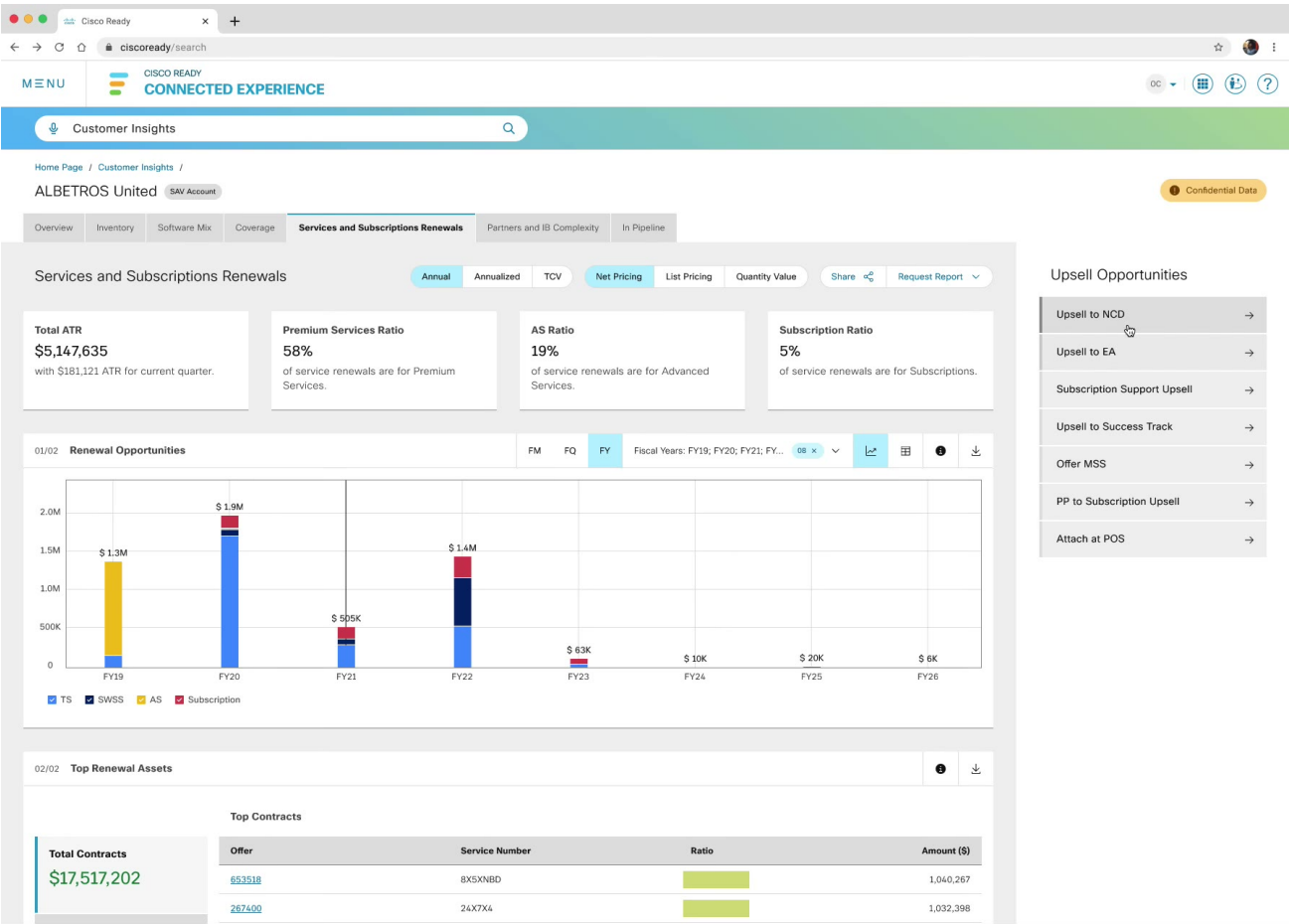


Image | Alt text: Framework for scaling contributed opportunity recommendations | Caption: Offers arrived in phases, could change over time, and always referenced an existing customer KPI. | Source asset: /assets/cisco/extension-constraints.png

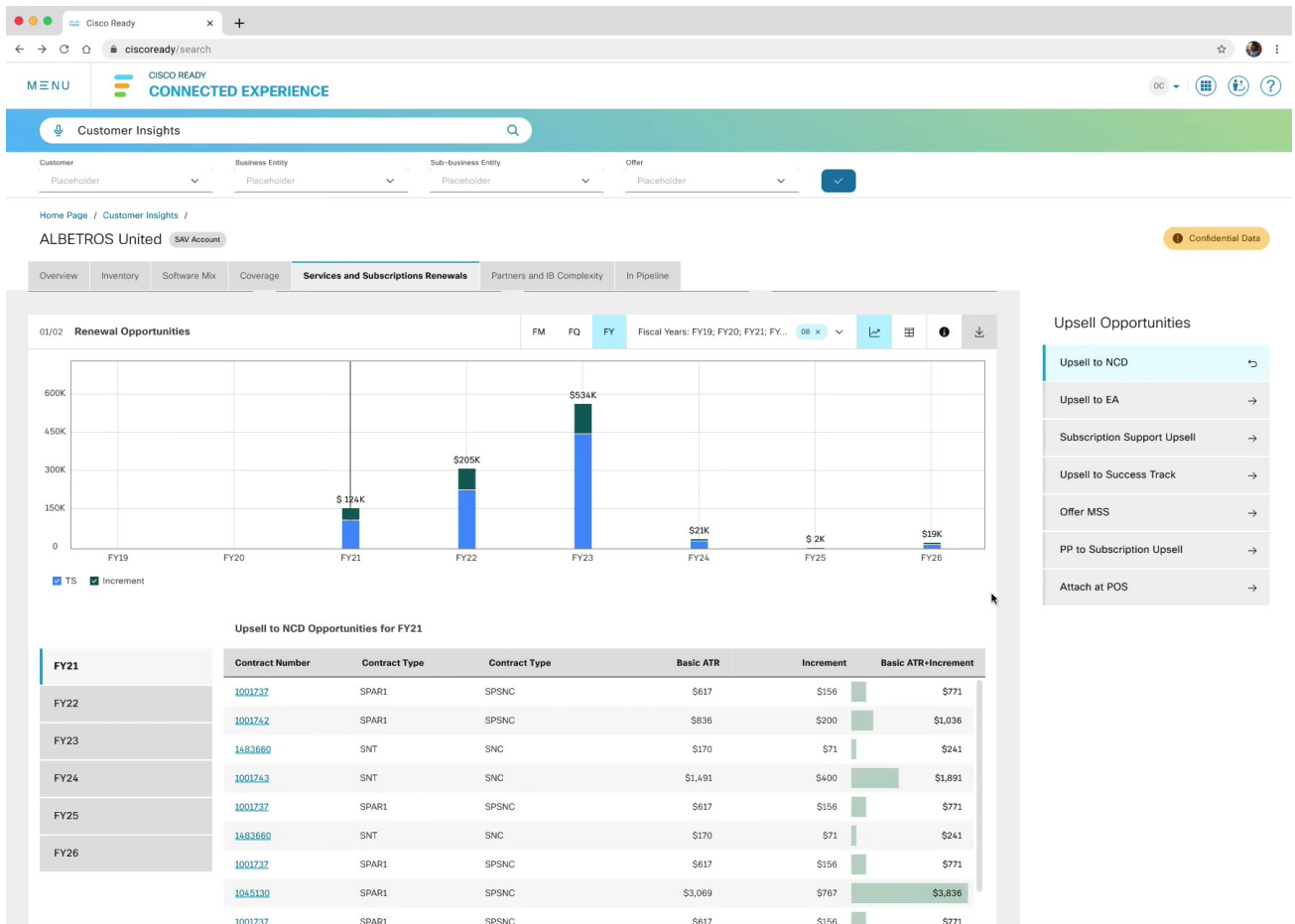
Testing Opportunity Placement

I tested panels, lists, overlays, and inline modules with account-team participants. People often overlooked the panel and list when they used internal program names, even when the panel occupied a quarter of the screen.

Internal program names did not explain why an offer mattered. I rewrote each offer around the action an account manager could take and the potential value for that customer.



Video poster | Alt text: Opportunity panel usability concept | Caption: Panel test: the large panel was easy to see, but participants still overlooked offers labeled with internal program names. | Source asset: /assets/cisco/video/opportunity-panel-test.webm



Video poster | Alt text: Opportunity list usability concept | Caption: List test: offers remained independent from the existing tiles, leaving room for more offers later. | Source asset: /assets/cisco/video/opportunity-list-test.webm

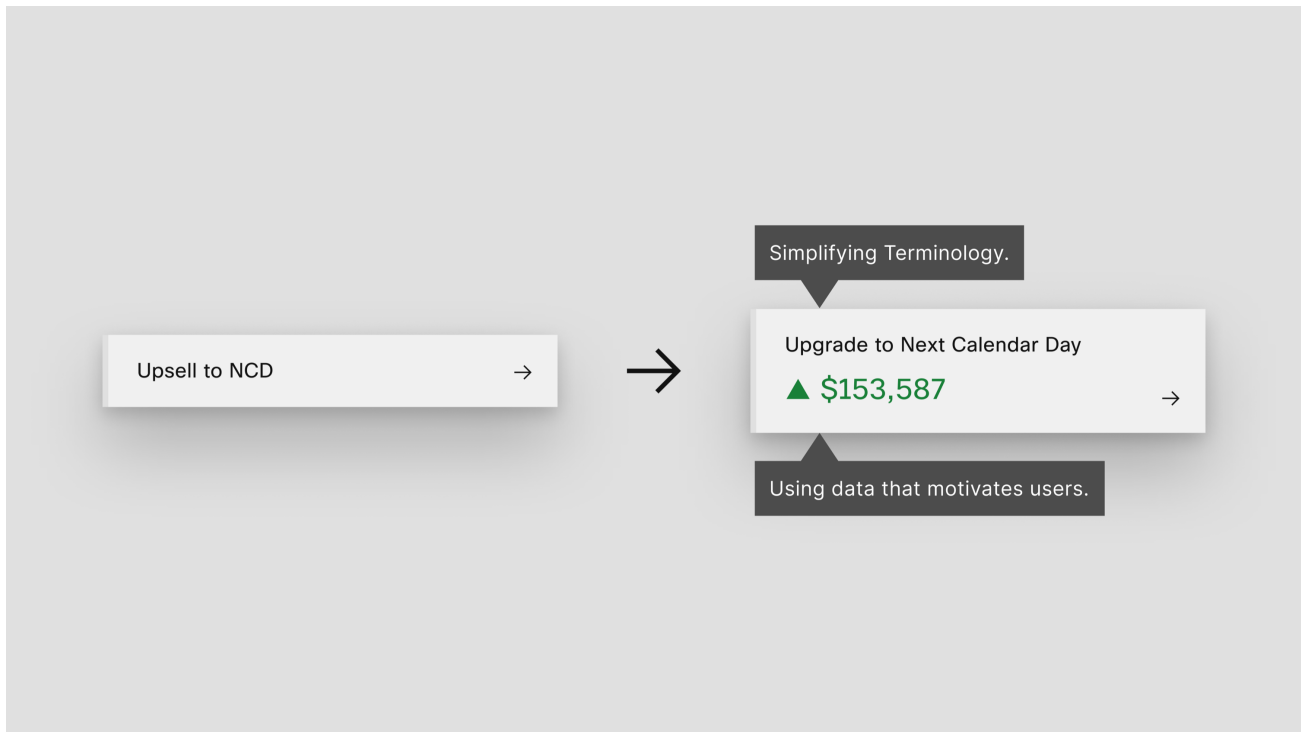


Image | Alt text: Opportunity card before and after copy refinement | Caption: “Upsell to NCD” became “Upgrade to Next Calendar Day,” paired with the potential value for that customer. | Source asset: /assets/cisco/opportunity-card-copy.png

Connecting Opportunities to Customer Data

I reviewed spreadsheets from the program teams and found that every offer reused a subset of data already shown in Customer Insights.

I treated each offer as a lens on that data. Selecting one filtered or expanded the existing charts and tables.

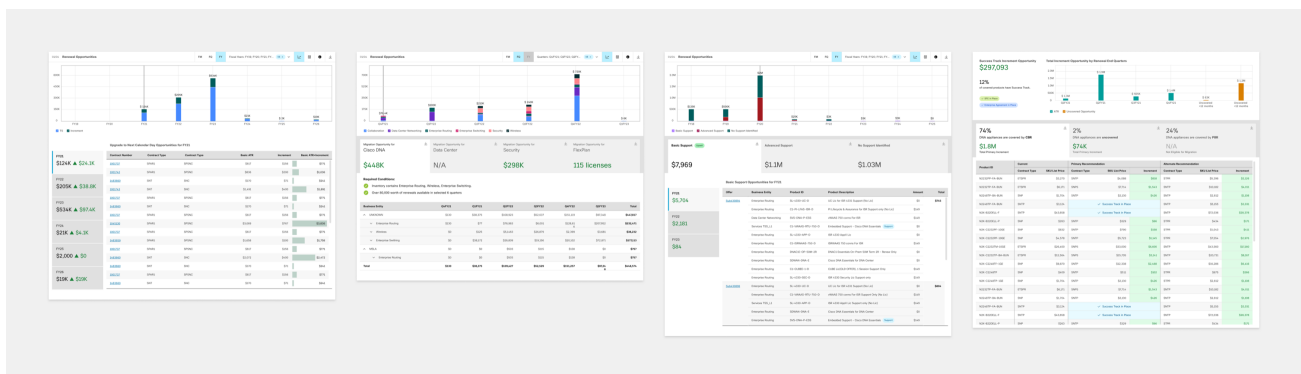


Image | Alt text: Several opportunities reusing subsets of Customer Insights data | Caption: Each offer filtered a different subset of data already available in Customer Insights. | Source asset: /assets/cisco/data-lens-model.png

Impact of Phase Two

Customer Insights became the only Cisco platform where account teams could analyze current customer data and identify growth opportunities in one place. At that point, Customer Insights supported four offers.

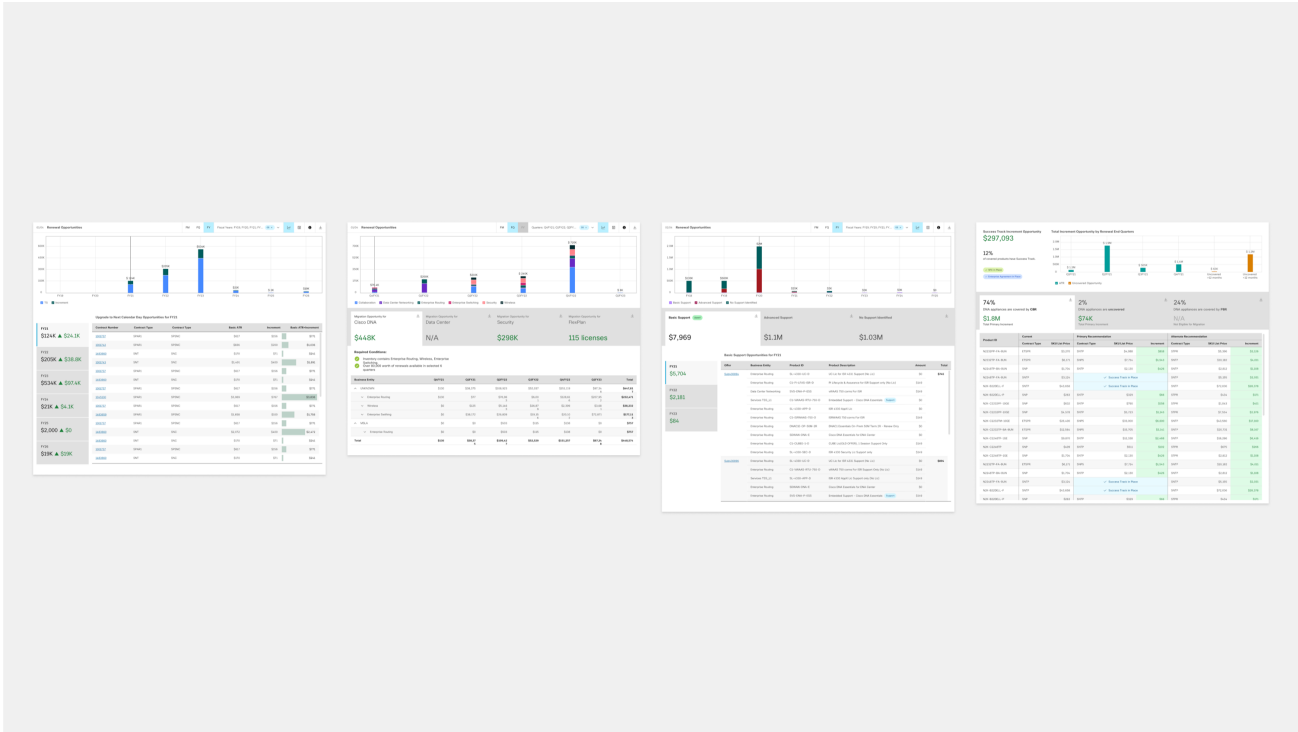


Image | Alt text: Four Upsell Opportunity views available in Customer Insights | Caption: Customer Insights supported four Upsell Opportunities at this stage. | Source asset: /assets/cisco/opportunity-collection.png

What I learned

Phase one: A clear research and design roadmap helped me win stakeholder support.

The roadmap showed why the research was necessary, which case studies informed the approach, and how long the work would take.

Phase two: I had to understand what motivated account managers to act.

They paid attention when an offer showed how it could help them reach quarterly or annual goals. A larger, brighter module alone had not produced that response.